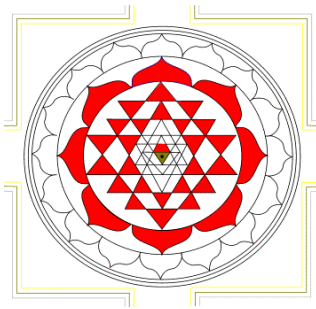




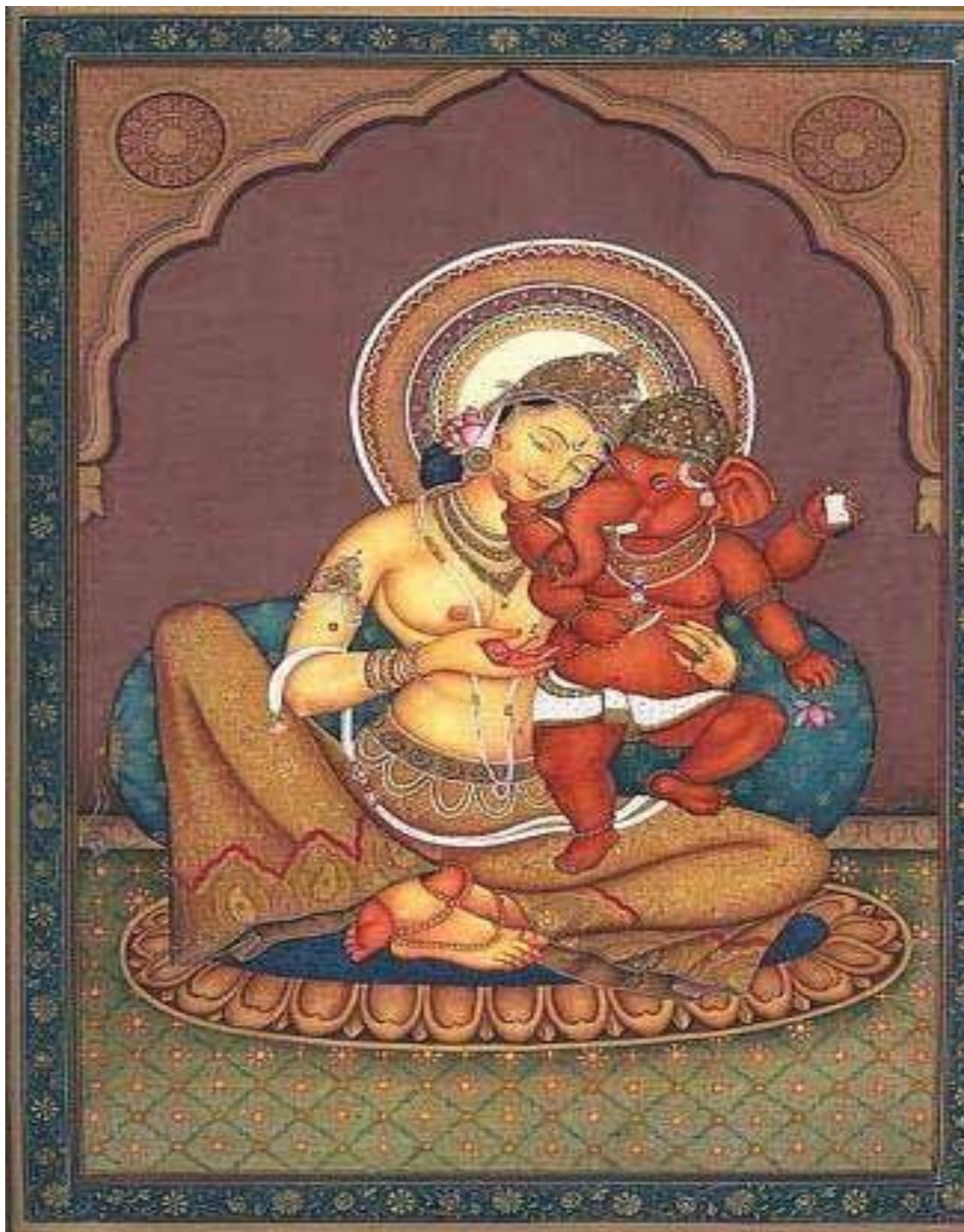
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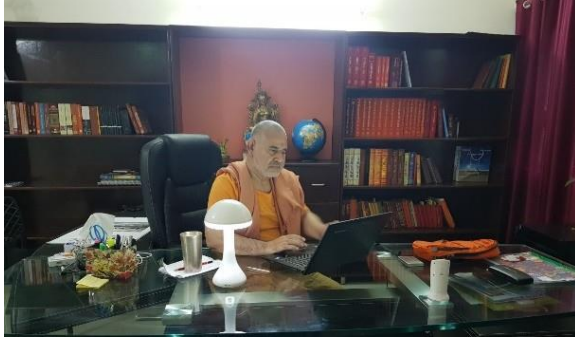
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1

EDITORIAL**The notion of ablution and purity in the agamas**

In one of his essays, Shri Aurobindo defines purity in terms of concentration and light. With it, concentration does its work, and without it, it will lead to peaceful quiescence or eternal repose, he writes in his synthesis of yoga. Switching the awareness to grosser and exterior phenomena towards a subtler and more pervasive aspect of nature is heading towards purity. The subtlest being - the universal “पुण्डरीकाक्ष”, the lotus-eyed one, purifies within and without just by his remembrance.

Purity and impurity are relative notions and are consistent only in the relative world. Both up to some extent are interdependent proclaims one mystic canon.

One who is well seated in the experience of one's identity with omnipresent Bhairava is exempt from purificatory ablutions, etc. This has also been indicated in the Gita while exonerating wisdom as compared to rites and rituals - “Nothing more sacred than wisdom can be conceived of” [nāhi jñānena sādṛiṣham pavitram iha vidyate]. Knowledge, says the Gita, the pure sovereignty light, is the source of all clearness. An ardent votary of pantheistic yogic philosophy, Shri Aurobindo, may have been referring to the significance of the śauca of purificatory ablutions, besides the protection of one's own organs and refraining from tactile contact with others - this essential part of the second limb of yoga also leads to essential purity's pleasant mindset, concentration, control over the irregular limbic movements and last but not the least, competence for self-realization. All five types of purities viz the purity of body, speech, earning, linen, and mind are temporal and need to be repeated too often. Identifying with one's essential nature leads to an awareness of one's permanent eternal purity - śuddham and āpāpavidhham [pure and untainted by vices]. Identification with one's pure and untainted nature is purity press, this is what all mystic and canons assert. Ritualistic cleanliness and ablutions are denied but one must not be particular only about them. The body is ever impure since it has to be purified and cleaned every day - the self is ever pure and needs no ablutions for its rectification once the difference between the two is clear - whose purification is required, says one less popular Vedantic treatise. The further details are there in the mystic canons all elementary constituents which are basically impure. They have to be purified through a process called - भूतशुद्धिः. This is presumably setting them in the right proportion as per the order of their creation - subtlety and pervasiveness. This is a subtler notion of

purity than the one that makes it too objective and gross. We search for this in water of certain description a sacred animal or its produces, sacrificial fire, rays of the sun and so on. The exterior concept of purity is based on many presuppositions and religious adherences and thus are not the absolute means or expressions of purity. These are means only in as much as they conduce to the experience of one's own all-pervasive, pure and alloyed nature. This *raison d'être* of ritualistic ablution only for the sake of ablution rejected many seers of mystic insight. Even Bhagavatam, which emphasizes faith and devotion as the means to salvation for a simpleton propounds यम *as more significant than नियम*. A man of divine wisdom should practise Yamas more intently otherwise he might as well be less particular about the niyamas [purity, contentment, moderation, study and docility]. Yamas and niyamas have been listed as slightly different from the yoga aphorisms which describe them as notwithstanding - both can be reconciled. Abhinav Guptacharya in his Malini Vijaya Vartika says purity and impurity are both relative and interdependent. The ever pure all-pervasive Bhairav is untainted by any impurity and manifests spontaneously as subjective and objective portions of the phenomena. This also asserts that exterior and gross purificatory rites and rituals are not the ultimate, but identification with one's pure subjective conscious nature is restoring your innate and inherent purity i.e. transcending all limiting three impurities that reduce shiva into a pashu. It must be mentioned here that the grossest of the three or five taints is Anav and pertains to the purificatory ablution of the gross body. This included almost everything that has been classified as cleanliness and hygiene. The rest of the Kalas refer to the purity of Subtle and causal bodies which as the school of thought goes, is much more signs to and can be accomplished without the preceding of gross cleanliness. Aldous Huxley in his jesting Pilate has mentioned a gaggle of unkempt dirty and foul-smelling mendicants, who to his astonishment were highly reverend men of god. They belonged to the first category. The other school of thought believes in the progressive notions of purity from gross to subtle. This one usually branded as orthodox does not like to bypass the conventional norms of ablution and at times consider them as a prerequisite to the subtler and subliminal variants of purity which is finally a resultant of the downing of the supreme wisdom. The popular adage of Ravidas, the cobbler saint who had realised god - "If the mind is pure even the water in a basin meant for cleaning leather is as pure as the Ganges." Nevertheless, he didn't refute that in order to purify the mind nothing is as conducive as taking a dip in the Ganges. Both of these streamlines of thoughts have been thriving side by side and are rarely ever conflicted. Abhinav Gupta, the author of Malini Vijay Vartikam has established the former ideology and asserted the futility of all material ablutions as compared to the purity that downs after the all-pervasive Bhairav, has been assimilated as one's own self and for that matter the self of the entire universe.

यमानभीक्षणशः सेवेत न तथा नियमान् बुधः । (भागवतम्)

अहिंसा सत्यब्रह्मचर्यस्तेयापरिग्रहा यमाः ।

*शौचसन्तोषतपःस्वाध्यायईश्वरप्रणिधानानि नियमाः ।

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Determining the classification of ‘Padartha’(categories) in the light of Siddhantabindu

- Prof. Satisha K

Classification of categories is an important topic of any philosophy. Different philosophies classify them differently; like – Nyaya vaisheshika and Sankhya have defined respectively 16, 6 and 25 classifications of categories. Generally, all these categories are summarized within Jiva (individual self), Jagad (material world) and Ishvara (the supreme atman). But depending upon respective philosophy, adjustments have been done in classification. In this regard, the discussion on the classification based on Advaita Vedanta philosophy is an excellent one both logically and scripturally.

Upanishads – whose only focus is to explain the non-dualistic unity of Brahman (eternal) and atman (self) are not interested in explaining the categories which are regarded as Mithya(false). Still, through adhyaropa-apavaada nyaaya (the idea of imposition and negation) determining the classification of the elements which would be instrumental in the realization of nondual Brahma. That is why our fore-teachers have already tried to classify the element here and there depending on the Upanishad texts. It is only because it is not their ultimate intention, different techniques have been adopted in classification(ie. A single unique way was not adopted for that). Somewhere the process explained by Nyaya theory has been adopted with simple corrections. Somewhere it is different. Here, the exposition by Siddhantabindu will be explained.

The book Siddhantabindu¹ was written by his holiness Sri Madhusoodana Saraswathi, depending on and interpreting Dashashloki of Sri Shankara Bhagavatpada. Here, all processes of Advaita Vedanta have been elaborated with proofs in the most logical way. Actually, this text is respected as the collective text for the philosophy of Advaita Vedanta by scholars.

Here, two types of elements are considered – Drik(the one who sees – viewer/witness) and Drishya(the one which is seen – view). All the elements conceptualized by all other plaintiffs are included within these two. Drik is Aatman (the self). He is the same and all-one in past, present and future times. Other than him is Drishya – this world -which is false. The inherent differences of these two were delineated with the example of the drawing board - will be elaborated now –

Drik element – the Aatman – even being one is told to be of three types due to differences in formalities(Upaadhi) as Ishvara(God), Jeeva(individual) and Saakshi(witness). The Vivaranakaras(writer of Vivarana script) explain them in this way - The original pure intelligence(bimba chaitanya) adjoined with Ajnaana(ignorance) is Ishwara². The spirit

¹ Siddhantabindu, Madhusoodana Saraswathi, Bhandarkar Oriental Research Institute, 1962[page no.8]

² During Creation, Ajnaana is covered by Antahkarana(mind), during destruction, it is covered by the Samskaras of mind - this is the differentiation. (सृष्टिकालेऽज्ञानमन्तःकरणावच्छिन्नं भवति, लयकाले तदन्तःकरणसंस्कारावच्छिन्नं भवतीति विवेकः)

reflected by ignorance(Ajnaana) which by itself is limited by mind and its samskaara(nature) is Jeeva. SankshepaShaareerakas explain it as - Chaitanya reflected by Ajnaana is Ishwara and that reflected by Buddhi(mind) is Jeeva. This same view is called as PratibimbaVaada(the theory of reflection). In the theory of writers of Vivarana, Jeeva and Ishwara are 'framed' by conceptualizing them as original and reflected self³. The concept can not be without any 'foundation'. This foundation of purity which is inherent in conformity within both is called Saakshi(the witness). In the view of Sankshepa-shaareerakas the original pure intelligence(Chaitanya) is the Saakshi.

According to Vachaspati Mishra, the Chaitanya subject to ignorance(Ajnana) is Ishwara. The one who shelters ignorance is Jeeva. In this theory, Saakshi is adjoined by avidyaa. This is what is called Avachchedavaada(theory of boundary).

Ishwara, again, is of three types depending on three characters of Maayaa which is his adjoin as – Brahma, VishNu and Rudra. The one covered with fundamental Sattva(virtue) nature is Vishnu, the protector⁴. The one covered with fundamental Rajas(vigor) nature is Brahmaa – the creator. The one with fundamental Tamas(inertia) nature is Rudra – the destroyer. In this way, the only one - Drik(the witness) also takes subclassifications that are essentially imaginary.

That is told in the following verse –

चिन्मयस्याद्वितीयस्य निष्कलस्याशरीरिणः ।
उपासकानां कार्यार्थं ब्रह्मणो रूपकल्पना ॥⁵

Even pure chit, nondual, void of any characteristic and formless Brahma is imagined as with form only to help the Upaasakas(devotees).

Jeeva is also of three types due to subclassification in his Upaadhi(support/formality) – as Vishwa, Taijasa and Praajna. Jeeva covered by visible bodily form due to Avidyantahkarana(mind formed by ignorance) in wake state is called Vishwa. The root 'Vish' means to enter. In the awakened state, Jeeva's 'entry' happens till the visible body – so is he called as Vishwa. The same Jeeva without attachment in the visible body, twofold covered by the formal ignorant mind is called Taijasa. Taijasa means lustrous. Even though he is ever shining with self-lustre, still his self-radiance is clearly evident in dream state. The one supported by only Avidyaa which is bounded by samskaras of mind is called Praajna. In the deep sleep state, due to the absence of flesh and mind, Avidyaa(Ignorance) becomes covered by only samskara of mind (mind in seed state). This (Praajna) is adjoined only with Avidyaa. Extensively knowledged is Praajna. All these three do not have different independent(unrelated) support, hence are one. But they are different due to sub- differences and thus classified so.

According to Vedanta Paribhaashaa Saakshin (witness) is of two types – Jeevasaakshi and

³ दर्पणाद्युपाध्यन्तर्गतत्वे सत्यौपाधिकपरिच्छेदशून्यत्वे च सति बहिःस्थितत्वरूपत्वं प्रतिबिम्बत्वम् ।
दर्पणाद्युपाध्यन्तर्गतत्वे सत्युपाध्यन्तर्गतरूपाऽभिन्नबहिःस्थितत्वं बिम्बत्वम् ।

⁴ जीवोपाध्यविद्यायामपि सत्त्वादयो गुणाः सन्ति त्रयः । तथापि ते त्रिगुणात्मकमूलप्रकृतेः कार्यरूपाः । अतोऽत्र कारणीभूतशब्देनाकार्यभूत इत्यवगन्तव्यम् । तेन जीवोपाधिगतसत्त्वगुणनिष्ठकर्मविशेषकारणतया जीवेऽतिव्याप्तिवारणाय विशेषणमिदमुपयुज्यते ।

⁵ श्रीरामपूर्वतापिनीयोपनिषत् – १.७

eeshvarasaakshi⁶. According to Siddhantabindu, there is only one, viz., The virtue which imposes Chaitanya(pure energy) to be the witness is one and same everywhere. Also, witnessing is the quality that is only devoted to Chaitanya. Thus, even in the presence of Upaadhi, there is no difference in witness.

Drishya or the 'scene' means a false object – Universe which is itself, made of(Tatkaarya) and pervaded by(Tadvyaapya) Avidya and which is imagined by Drik(viewer). The infinite link between Avidyaa and Chit(pure self) etc., should be put under the category Vyaapya since they are not considered as 'made' or 'effected'. This drishya is of three types – Avyaakruta, Amoortha and Moorta.

Avidyaa(ignorance), Combination of Avidya and chit(pure energy), Difference between Jiva(individual) and Isha(God) and Chidaabhaasa are the four which are called by name Avyaakruta. Avidya is Ishwara's(God's) supernatural power. Even though passive, she is immaculate by nature and hence the 'life'(Chaitanya) of Atma is reflected there. That is what is called Chidaabhaasa. Three Padarthas said before which are different than Avidyaa are pervaded by Avidyaa. This avidyaa is the seed power of this world in its manifested or unmanifested form⁷.

This Avidyaa though lifeless, powered by Chidaabhaasa, being motivated by previous samskaras and Jeeva's actions creates the five essential elements namely - space, wind, fire, water and earth which are characteristic of sound, touch, form, juice and smell respectively. There, She, with previous forms causes the forms of successions and hence the transition of characters of previous elementary groups into the later elements.

Even darkness of this Avidya is 'existent' in nature, engulfing, an opposer of visual perception, destroyed by light, suddenly emerges and disappears just like lightning. Directions can be shown and practiced as and in space only and hence are not told separately. Time is also Avidyaa only in all-supporting form because she is also considered as the basis of every creation.

Previously said five major elements fivefold or not fivefold, have the attributes Sattva(virtue), Rajas(vigor) and Tamas(inertia) just like their cause. All these, mixed together with virtue as the main attribute create one immaculate element having the force of knowledge and action. There, the part with knowledge force is main, is called Antahkarana(mind). The same is also called as Manas and buddhi due to different vocations. The part where the action is the main force is called Praana(Pneuma/breath)⁸. This also is classified as five types - Praana, apaana, vyaana, udaana and samaana based again on their vocations. In this way, both Pneuma and mind are essentially conceptually one and the same. There, the mind with determination is buddhi and that with dubitation is called manas.

In this way, every element specialized with knowledge force and action force generates two sense organs each. Like – Space creates the sense organ – ear by knowledge force and

⁶Vedantapariibhaashaa – With Maniprabhaa and ShikhaamaNi, Dharmarajadhvarindra, edit-Prof.Parasanath Dvivedi, Sampurnananda Sanskrit University, Varanasi, 2000[page no. 114]

⁷अयं चाव्याकृतपदार्थ ईश्वरोपाधिः ।

This is the Avyakrita element adjoining Ishwara.

⁸हृदि प्राणो गुदेऽपानः समानो नाभिसंस्थितः । उदानः कण्ठदेशस्थो व्यानः सर्वशरीरगः ॥

Amarakosha, Amarasimha, edit-N. Ranganathasharma, Kaavyaalaya, Mysore, 2013[page no. 14]

speech organ by action force. In the same way, from the air(Vaayu) are generated the organs - skin and hand; Eye and foot by the fire element; Tongue and urinary tract by water element; Nose and rectum by the earth element. Here, this has to be noted that the quality/character related to a particular major element is perceived by the sense organ created by that particular element. For example, sound is the quality of space and is perceived by the sense organ ear – which is born of space itself.

Even the abiding Gods of these sense organs are mainly with knowledge force and action force. There are – the dweller Gods of the ear are directions(Dishah), and that for speech is Agni(fire god). In the respective manner, the Gods Vaata and Indra, Aditya and Vishnu, VaruNa and Mitra, Ashvini and Prajapati are for remaining organs. Here, the knowledge force grouped together form AntahkaraNam(mind). Action force grouped together form Praana(Pneuma).

The five sense organs, five action organs, five breaths, mind and intelligence said before are together called as Saptadashaka-lingam(The abstract group of seventeen). The same is called as Hiranyagarbha when knowledge force plays the main role and as Sootra when action force becomes main. The same is called an unmanifested element. This binds to only Jeeva(individual) in both vyashti(individuality) and samashti(wholeness).

The same previously said five major elements become fivefold which were not so before. Here, one part among each division is again divided into four. These four parts enter the parts of other four elements other than themselves. In this way, the PanchekaraNa(fivefold division) happens by adding half of an element with one-eighths of the other four elements. The naming is done according to the majority of the respective element in each group. This is what is been explained in Brahmasutra – वैशेष्यात्तु तद्वादस्तद्वादः (2.4.22)⁹. These fivefold elements(pancheekruta) are said to be manifested(Moorta). These manifested elements create the dwelling place of sense organs, the house of all sorts of enjoyments – the body. Thus, amoortha(unmanifested) by avyaakruta and moorta(manifested) by amoortha are created. This is how his holiness Madhusoodana Saraswathi has explained the elements.

While expounding the order in which the world is created, it is told that just by the very thought of Ishwara along with Maayaa the unfivefold subtle elements are generated. These elements are the effect of Maaya with three qualities hence are also with three qualities. Here, there will be the mutual mixture of the passive parts of space etc- the five elements.

This is by these passive or inertiativ unfivefold elements, the fivefold elements are formed. This happens in the following way – the five major elements - space, wind, fire, water and earth – each merge with other elements. Each of the five elements is first divided into two and the second part is again divided into four parts. These four parts are put in other four elements one part in each. Thus the process is explained.

Here, at the start, the space is divided into two equal parts and again, one part among them should be divided into four equal parts. These four parts are then put into other four elements¹⁰. In the same way, the wind is divided into two parts, one part among which is

⁹ Brahmasuutra Shankarabhaashyam –with Bhamati-Kalpataru-Parimala-Vyakhya, Bhagavan AdiShankara, edit- Intro by AnantakrishnaShastri, Chaukhamba Samskrit Series, Varanasi, vikrama.era.2039[page no.653]

¹⁰ तत्राकाशस्य स्वार्धेन भूतान्तरागतपादचतुष्केण च पञ्चीकरणम्(ब्र.सू.शां.भा.१.१.४);Brahmasuutra Shankarabhaashyam –with Bhamati-Kalpataru-Parimala-Vyakhya, Bhagavan AdiShankara, edit- Intro by AnantakrishnaShastri, Chaukhamba Samskrit Series, Varanasi, vikrama.era.2039[page no.100]

again divided into four equal parts which are placed in the four elements like space other than itself. The same process is for fire etc. In this way, every element is half of itself and the other half is of the other four elements. Thus, the five elements are called by their name where that part itself is abundant. Like earth has half of the earth element in it¹¹. In the same way, each group of fivefold elements is called by its abundant element. i.e., PanchaekaraNa is the process of dividing each of five elements like Space into two equal parts, again dividing the first five parts among these ten parts into four equal parts and putting these four small parts into the remaining four main parts leaving out their own parts¹². The same thing has been elaborated in Brahmasootra-bhaashya also. In Sanjnaamoortikrupatyadhikarana(संज्ञामूर्तिकल्पव्यधिकरणम् –ब्र.सू.2.4.9)¹³ the same topic has been discussed.

If everything in the physical world is made fivefold, then it is heard that they are also divided as told by Chandogya.6.3.3¹⁴ – त्रिवृतं त्रिवृतमेकैकां करवाणि (Let me make each of them into three threefold) and particular discretion in the same as in इदं तेज इमा आप इदमन्नम् is also heard. Then the question arises that how does the particularity in the elements happen. The answer is वैशेष्यात् तद्वादस्तद्वादः(ब्र.सू. 2.6.11)¹⁵. There, it has been explained that even though Trivrutkarana has been done, somewhere abundance of some elementary mass like the fire has an abundance of lustre(pure fire). water has abundance in water and earth in earthiness. This threefolding was done following the routine practice. Thus, even though threefolding is there, because of the particularity of element, this particular-fire-water-earth-theory applies regarding elementary physics¹⁶. Thus the process of Panchaekarana has been explained.

The five-elemental body (paanchabhautikam shareeram) is formed by the mingling of the same elements but not fivefold. This body is classified into two types – gross and subtle.

There, the subtle body is called lingashareera. This lingashareera administers the afterworld journey and also remains till salvation. This is also called the 'group of seventeen' by having five sense organs, five action organs, five breathes, mind and intelligence.

This subtle body is again of two types by names – para(eternal) and apara(other)¹⁷. Para is the subtle body of Hiranyagarbha also determined by the word 'Mahattatva'. Apara is

¹¹ Vedantaparibhaashaa – With Maniprabhaa and ShikhaamaNi, Dharmarajadhvarindra, edit- Prof.Parasanath Dvivedi, Sampurnananda Samskrit University, Varanasi, 2000[page no. 390]

¹² Vedantasaara, Sadanandayogindra, Chaukhambavidyabhavanam, Varanasi, 2008[page no.42]

¹³ Brahmasuutra Shankarabhaashyam –with Bhamati-Kalpataru-Parimala-Vyakhya, Bhagavan AdiShankara, edit- Intro by AnantakrishnaShastri, Chaukhamba Samskrit Series, Varanasi, vikrama.era.2039[page no.639]

¹⁴ Ishaadidashopanishadah – shaankarabhaashyam, Bhagavan Adishankara, Motilal Banarsidas, Varanasi, 1978[page no. 513]

¹⁵ Brahmasuutra Shankarabhaashyam –with Bhamati-Kalpataru-Parimala-Vyakhya, Bhagavan AdiShankara, edit- Intro by AnantakrishnaShastri, Chaukhamba Samskrit Series, Varanasi, vikrama.era.2039[page no.641]

¹⁶ There itself[page no. 641]

¹⁷ Vedantaparibhaashaa – With Maniprabhaa and ShikhaamaNi, Dharmarajadhvarindra, edit- Prof.Parasanath Dvivedi, Sampurnananda Samskrit University, Varanasi, 2000[page no. 392]

the subtle body of individuals like ours and is also determined by the word ‘Ahamkaara’. About lingashareera(subtle body) –

बुद्धिकर्मेन्द्रियप्राणपञ्चकैर्मनसा धिया ।

शरीरं सप्तदशभिः सूक्ष्मं तल्लिङ्गमुच्यते ॥ १.२३ ॥¹⁸

by Panchadashi is the proof. Also the Vedic text -

कर्मात्मा त्वपरे योऽसौ मोक्षबन्धैस्स युज्यते ।

स सप्तदशकेनाऽपि राशिना युज्यते पुनः ॥ (ब्र.सू.शा.भा.२.३.४७)¹⁹

is the proof.

Gross body is of four types – Jaraayuja, Andaja, udbhijja and Swedaja. Jarayujas are the species born from the uterus - like humans, animals, etc. Andajas²⁰ are born from eggs like - birds, reptiles, etc., Swedajas are born from sweat - like lice, mosquitoes, etc. Udbhijjas are the ones that pierce apart and are born from within the earth – like plants. By the texts like शरीरजैः कर्मदोषैर्याति स्थावरतां नरः (Manusmrithi. 12.9)²¹, it can be understood that even the physiques like trees have the body to experience sorrow due to the sinful birth. It is by fivefold mixed fundamental elements, this whole universe containing fourteen realms/worlds is created. Among fourteen, Atala, Vitala, Sutala, Talaatala, Mahaatala, Rasaatala and Paataala are the seven downward worlds. Bhuumi(Earth), Anthariksha, Svar, Maho, Janas, Tapas and Satya are the seven upward worlds.

Thus, the classification of elements according to Siddhantabindu has been elaborated.

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1. Amarakosha, Amarasimha, edit-N. Ranganathasharma, Kaavyaalaya, Mysore, 2013
2. Ishaadidashopanishadah – shaankarabhaashyam, Bhagavan Adishankara, Motilal Banarsidas, Varanasi, 1978
3. Upanishatsangraha, edit- Pandita Jagadeesha Shastri, Motilal Banarsidas, Reprinted edition, Delhi, 1998
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List of Abbreviations

1. तै.उ – तैत्तिरीयोपनिषत्
2. छा.उ – छान्दोग्योपनिषत्

3. मु.उ – मुण्डकोपनिषत्
4. ब्र.सू – ब्रह्मसूत्रम्
5. ब्र.सू.शा.भा – ब्रह्मसूत्रशाङ्करभाष्यम्
6. म.स्मृ. मनुस्मृतिः
7. ऋ.सं – ऋग्वेदसंहिता
8. अ.को – अमरकोशः

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This article is an English rendering of a Sanskrit article published in a philosophy journal by the author)

3

Parapsychological Phenomena 2**- Bhoomi Sati****Mind Reading –**

Mindreading is the ability to read people's minds without using normal forms of communication, especially via the use of supernatural power. Mentalism is a phrase that encompasses a variety of performance arts such as hypnosis, telepathy, clairvoyance, psychokinesis, mind reading, and even quick math. While some of the techniques used by mind readers today have the potential to shock and amaze audiences, many of the presentation styles date back hundreds, if not thousands, of years, with accounts of mentalists performing such acts appearing in ancient Greek literature and the Bible's Old Testament. There are reports in the Christian mystic book *Philokalia* of old hermit monks who telepathically dictated an entire volume to their novice monk who was located elsewhere. This skill can be acquired only through intuition.

According to the third chapter yogic sutra it is mentioned, “kshana tathkramayoh samyamad vivekajam jnanam”. The rendering of this sutra is – by meditating on the modification of time fraction. Kshana is time fraction and kramayoh is the order of its modification. A man acquires the highest discriminative knowledge by focusing on moments and sequences. These events, motions, and changes in nature are created to be captured by our faculties. We can detect even the tiniest and most subtle changes taking place around us. We're dealing with photosensitive, vibratory sensitive, impact sensitive, and even molecular sensitive situations. We are nothing more than a collection of sensors. Every cell is a sensor in and of itself, and each cell is intended to detect changes in the environment. Some of us merely utilise our senses to notice the ordinary changes, but others, such as yogis, may use them to their utmost extent. Through their trained sensibilities, yogis could detect even the tiniest shift. This is how mind reading works. It's as though you're picking up on micro-expressions. At the physical level, every mental thought has an outward manifestation. Your thoughts are reflected in your eyes, eye movements, face muscles, gestures, posture, body motions, and occasionally in your body odour. As a result, each thought has a subtle impact on the entire body. Reading people's minds via observing small changes and micro-expressions. This skill can only be acquired through intuition. The more alert and aware one becomes, the more minute details surface in their consciousness. Through these little details, the subconscious develops the ability to interpret someone else's thoughts. Another key requirement for reading someone's mind is that the reader's mind is peaceful, straightforward, and devoid of any impressions. Because one's thinking is reflected in their aura and demeanor, it's incredibly easy to comprehend someone without really meeting them and only looking at them. The reader can detect what form of ailment one is suffering from or what type of mental tension one is experiencing. All this calmness and clarity in one's thoughts can come from yoga and meditation. Yoga sutra refers to this pure state of awareness as “vaisha hradyey” and in this state one's consciousness is always truth-bearing - rtambhara tatra prajna. You see and you know what the truth is and only in this state of rtambhara can you read somebody's mind perfectly. Chitta means individual consciousness, which covers all states conscious, subconscious and unconscious. An accomplished yogi can read others' minds and thoughts by focussing on his chitta. So, to read somebody's mind, the person must first train himself to read his own mind. One must learn to be so quiet that they could come to a state which is called as “no thought state”, or a pure and peaceful state. In this state, one can see things very clearly. According to 3/53 of Patanjali's yog sutram, “Pratyayasya parchitt jnanam” which means that by

concentrating on the meaning part of the expression one can read other's mind as well.

There is also a relation between mind-reading and psychology. In their performances, mind readers and mentalists employ psychological principles. They're employing the art of interpreting body language, gestures, and motions, as well as a variety of other subtle cues or clues, to figure out what the individual is thinking. Prior to being labeled as a sort of magic, mentalism was regarded as a genuine subject of scientific research, serving as a forerunner to current Freudian and Jungian psychology.

Telepathy-

Telepathy is the direct transmission of thoughts from one person to another without the use of traditional sensory routes of communication and is thus a type of extrasensory perception (ESP). While telepathy's existence has yet to be proven, numerous parapsychological research investigations have yielded promising results. Telepathy has a long history dating back to the Egyptians and Greeks. Egyptians thought that a spirit would communicate with people through dreams. Dreams were also thought to be a way for the Greeks to communicate. Many indigenous people have kept ancient information such as dreams, telepathy, and so on. The birth of the concept of telepathy in Western civilization, according to historians such as Roger Luckhurst and Janet Oppenheim, may be traced back to the late 19th century and the creation of the Society for Psychical Research. Scientific principles were applied to mental phenomena (e.g., animal magnetism) as the physical sciences advanced, in the hopes of better understanding paranormal occurrences. In this framework, the contemporary concept of telepathy arose. Telepathy is a type of extrasensory perception that is commonly characterized alongside precognition and clairvoyance in parapsychology (ESP). Experiments used by parapsychologists to test for telepathic powers have been recorded.

Telepathy is a mental capability that the mind can develop. The mind contains various faculties, and for the most part, many of these faculties do not express themselves in such a way that the individual who manifests the talent is aware of. When one practices yoga, particularly meditation, the power to exhibit mental capacities such as telepathy can be developed. When the mind acquires the ability to be still and develops what is known as "access concentration," this ability is amplified. When one has learnt to quiet the mind to the point where one acquires access to concentration, telepathy can materialize or emerge from the mind's well. When one meditates and develops such capacity, the earliest stages of Jhana bliss are usually experienced or begin to be experienced. Yoga practitioners are more likely to gain control over their telepathic experiences and to encounter additional mental capacities.

There are numerous words in the Sanskrit language to denote various mental states. "Chitta" is the name given to one component of the mind. Chitta refers to the innermost core of the mind, which is your link to what we call consciousness. You can access your consciousness if your chitta becomes awakened and gains enough conscious control. So, if one's chitta becomes even slightly aware, one's ability to not just express an idea or a notion, but also to physically deliver something becomes possible.

The study of mystical and metaphysical issues is a focus of Kundalini yoga. It is a powerful and energetic technique that has its origins in the Himalayan ancient culture. It is concerned with the study of the human body's chakra system. In kundalini yoga, an eighth chakra is added to the set of seven. The master chakra, also known as the guru chakra, is the eighth chakra. As a Kundalini Yoga practitioner, one will learn to connect with these energy centers. This knowledge leads to the alignment of the body and energy centers, which has the potential to be transformative. Kundalini yoga has several health advantages for the body, mind, and soul. Kundalini yoga has numerous health benefits, including physical and emotional well-being. It improves one's perception and intuition,

as well as giving its user several metaphysical abilities. This encompasses telepathy, telekinesis, clairvoyance, and other talents.

It's all down to the strength of our minds. With the help of meditation or concentration, we can attain telepathy. Sages of the Satyuga era employed telepathic abilities to communicate with people's minds. A person is regarded to be a man of great knowledge when he learns about someone's thinking or witnesses and recounts a faraway incident. During the Mahabharata time, Sanjay possessed this skill. He described the war that was taking place far away in Dhritarashtra.

To sum up, telepathy is a mental capacity that can be developed by the mind which can be derived to one's inner strength, especially of their minds. Yoga and meditation, which deepens one's concentration can help attain telepathy. Yoga has the ability to strengthen and transfer thoughts in a positive manner. When the aspirant is able to master this strengthening, they can attain the power of telepathy.

4.

Pratyabhijna made easy 6&7

(Through this column Pratyabhijna made easy - aspirants can easily assimilate the purport and motif of pratyabhijna Hridayam)

Sutra six and exposition

तन्मयः मायाप्रमाता।

6th Aphorism

Tanmayo Maya Pramata

Maya pramata is made up of Chittam.

Body, Mind and spirit are made with a predominance of chittam and chittam is nothing but chiiti in it's contracted form. Even the state of Shunya (void) is not free of impressions or samaskaras of Chiti and though in a dormant state Chiti is always present. Had Chiti been absent in the state of absorption upon arising there shouldn't be the same experience again to establish the self as Chittam and consciousness two aphorisms are cited in Shiva Sutras.

1. The self is Consciousness (Chaitanyah Atma)
2. The self is Chittam (Chittam Atma)

Upon synthesizing both the aphorisms mean what we have discussed in the preceding two sutras, the self is all conscious (ness) and the self is Chittam which is also all consciousness in its real nature. The self who is conscious is also Chittam in its conditioned manifestation.

This must be explained in order to ascertain the nature of the self. Since a correct notion of the self leads to emancipation and an aberrant one to the miseries of mortal existence, therefore, the seventh aphorism says:

“Sa cheko Dvirupasya Trimayasaya Chaturatma Sapt Panchak Svabhavah”.

Questions:

1. Tanmaya in this sutra means:
 - a. Made of Chittam
 - b. One pointed
 - c. In unison with
 - d. None of the above
2. Even the state of void contains the impression of Chittam - implies that
 - a. There is no shunyam
 - b. The witness of void is Maya Pramata
 - c. Even in the casual state, the impetus of activity persists
 - d. b & c
3. Both Sutras “Chaitanyah Atma” and “ Chittam Atma” taken together mean that_____

Pratyabhijna made easy 7

Sutra : Sa chaiko Dvirupaha Trimayas Chaturatma Sapt Panchak Svabhavah

स चैको द्विरूपः त्रिमयः चतुरात्मा सप्तपञ्चकस्वभावः

Translation: Since the correct knowledge of the self leads to emancipation and incorrect one to bondage, the real and correct nature of the self must be ascertained completely. Thus the seventh aphorism.

Exposition:

Despite being one he assumes, three, four and thirty-five forms (7 and 5) forms respectively.

Why one?

Shiva Bhattacharya alone is the universal self-one without a second. Because the self-effulgent subjective consciousness cannot be conditioned in time and space and an insentient entity can never be subjectively conscious.

Why twofold?

The prakasha of his own accord accepts contractions in the form of prana etc. becomes the conditioned experient of this experience. In this way, it assumes two forms

1. Pure Subjective Consciousness
2. The experiencer of the conditioned objectivity

The trifurcation explained:

Owing to the three taints (mala) viz. Anava, Mayiya and Karmic, the subjective awareness becomes threefold hence Trimaya

Four forms:

Owing to grosser manifestations of Shunya, Prana and eight categories of Puryastakam and the Gross body it assumes four-fold forms Hence Chaturatma

Of the nature of thirty-five elements Siva to Prithvi (presumably Siva and Shakti taken as one).

Another interpretation of seven and five:

Seven elements from Siva to Sakala-Shiva as five Shaktis Jnana, Iccha, Kriya, Chit, and Anand. This universal self can lead to emancipation only if intuitively recognised as mentioned above. otherwise, it leads to a divergence which culminates into the miseries of samsara or material existence.

Questions

1. Twofold refers to bifurcation
 - a. Yes
 - b. No
 - c. Can't say

2. The same subjective awareness upon getting conditioned assumes two forms: With one she remains pure unconditioned awareness and with other experiences
 - a. Yes
 - b. No
 - c. Can't say
3. The three taints are Anav, Mayiya and Kayla
 - a. Yes
 - b. No
 - c. Can't say
4. Explain the two renderings of the phrase Saptpanchakam in detail

(Paranand Swami from YTA Google class room)

5

A poem by prof Ambika Talwar .

If the wound is the place where light enters through,
 then I am shot with white and gold;
 I pulse infinitely in geometric patterns.

If the wound is point of origins,
 the gate after gate of heaven, then my body-being
 must be the paradise I had quite forgotten.

I ask for that wholeness to enwrap me
 beyond time and fragmentation.

If wound you speak of is a paradigm of welcome,
 then I am that curtain that parts and all light subsumes
 my all and you – for what is a repast made of?

If wound is a cry of longing, then light is that love
 that makes me whole and you. Stitches us up
 with sutures beyond skin – nerves enlivening

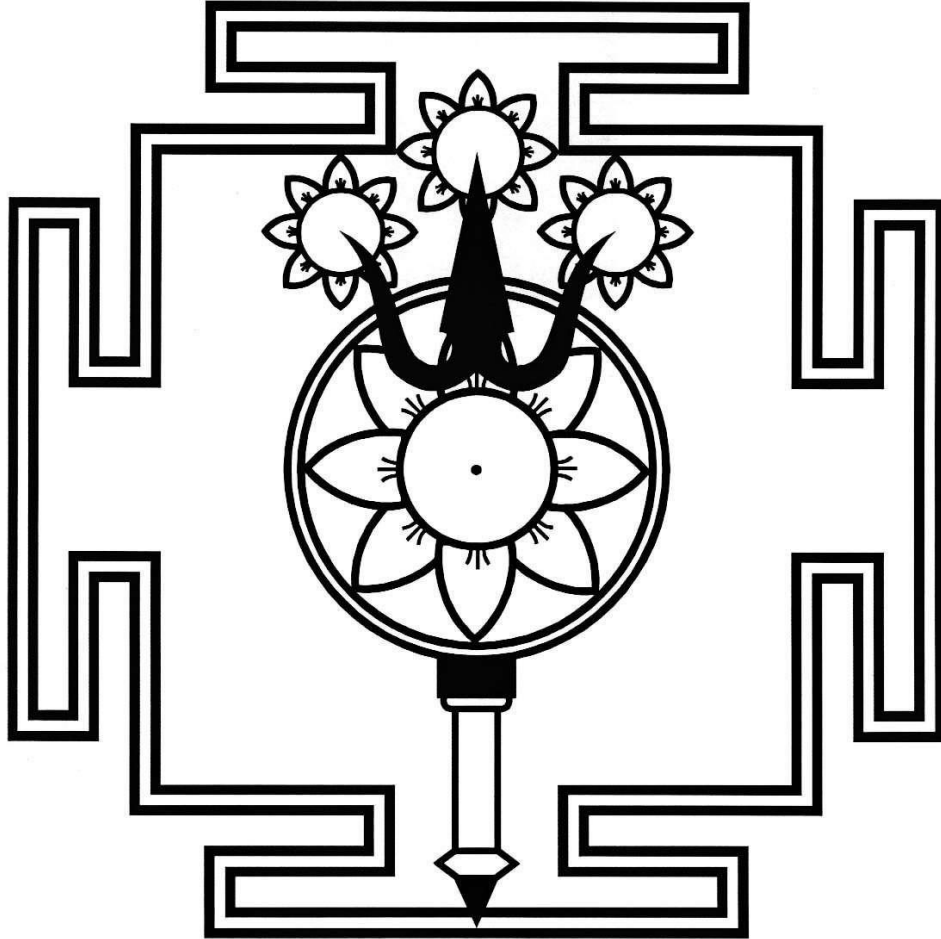
even passersby waiting for a sip of rain.

This bird of my heart sings, so I be not forgotten,
 nor the hem of my skirt

The poetess is a professor of creative arts in the US. She has borrowed the idea from Jalaluddin Rumi's pessimistic pathetic reflections. Metaphysical orientation of pain, sufferings and mortification is the underlying streamline of consciousness in this poem)



Paranand Swami at chandratal



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